

received a boost with the vision of legendary game developer Shigeru Miyamoto, who infused life into gaming by blending art and story-telling into the mixture.

Names like *Super Mario Bros* and *The Legends of Zelda* quickly became known across the world and in every home, even those in India. And true to Miyamoto's vision, the games transcended all ages, sexes and other demographics to truly reach out to the family at large.

In fact, one of this author's earliest memories is that of his father's daily morning routine of 'tea, newspapers, quick round of *Super Mario Bros 3*, shower, breakfast, leave for office'.

During the era of the NES, the power scales of the video game industry shifted. Nintendo now reigned supreme, with Sega catching up fast. Atari, the market leader for all these years, was now relegated to an 'also-ran' slot and was eventually never able to get out of that rut.



NES brought the idea of 'family entertainment' to the world of video games



16-bit gaming came with the Sega Genesis (pictures) and the Super NES

After the hoopla surrounding the NES died down, PCs became the weapon of choice for most gamers, as graphics on the computer began improving rapidly. The console industry needed to come up with a reply quickly, and this was provided by Sega in the form of the first 16-bit console, the Sega Genesis, in 1989.

This launch was soon followed by Nintendo releasing the 16-bit Super NES (SNES) two years later, sparking the first of the video game console wars, complete with pot shots, fake marketing claims and the works!

The jump to 16-bit chips, however, still did not bring high-quality 3D graphics to video games. Most of the games for consoles were still 2D, with the occasional title such as *Virtua Racing* demonstrating the possibilities of upcoming 3D technologies.